

Liminal Apprentice Case Assessment

AI / Software Engineering Track

Role	Apprentice, AI / Software Engineering
Format	Take-home
Duration	3–5 days
Deliverable	Your choice – see below
Audience	Hiring Team (including Liminal's Head of Engineering & AI)

The Context

Liminal is a Founder's Studio. We co-found companies with seasoned founders and build alongside them – from MVP to Series B and beyond. We move fast, operate lean, and everyone on the team needs to punch well above their weight.

We're building our Apprenticeship Programme to bring in sharp, hungry builders who may not yet have a decade of experience – but have the instincts, curiosity, and drive to do the work of someone who does.

AI changes the game. The best engineers today don't compete on what they already know. They compete on how fast they learn, how creatively they use the tools available, and how clearly they think about problems that don't have obvious answers yet.

The Brief

The Problem

You've just joined Liminal as an AI / Software Engineering Apprentice, and your team is working on three active venture projects simultaneously. You have real ownership from day one – but your current skills only cover part of what the work demands. How do you maximise your impact, starting now?

This is an open-ended brief. There is no single correct answer. What we're evaluating is how you think, how you approach ambiguity, and what you choose to build or propose.

Concretely, we'd like you to explore the following:

1. **Identify the gap.** What capabilities or tasks would typically be beyond an engineer joining at your stage? Be specific – pick a real domain (e.g. full-stack development, data pipelines, QA automation, product scoping, documentation, code review).

2. **Design the solution.** How would you use AI – tools, workflows, agents, or integrations – to bridge that gap and deliver at a level above your current capabilities? Show us the thinking, not just the tools.
3. **Prove it (if you can).** If you're able to, build something – a prototype, a working script, a prompt system, an agent workflow, or any artefact that demonstrates your approach. If you can't build it in the time available, show us the blueprint and walk us through what you'd do with more runway.
4. **Reflect on the limits.** Where does AI augmentation break down? What still requires human judgment? What would you need to learn to take this further?

What to Submit

There is no prescribed format. You could submit any of the following – or a combination:

- A written proposal or strategy doc
- A working prototype or code repository
- A short recorded walkthrough (5–10 min)
- A slide deck
- A prompt system, agent spec, or architecture diagram
- Something else entirely – if it communicates your thinking clearly

Whatever you submit, make sure it answers the four questions above. Depth matters more than polish. We'd rather see a rough prototype with sharp thinking than a beautiful deck with shallow ideas.

What We're Looking For

We will assess your submission across four dimensions:

Problem Clarity	Did you pick a real, specific problem? Is your framing sharp and grounded?
AI Fluency	Do you understand what AI can and can't do? Is your solution thoughtful and plausible, not just a list of tool names?
Execution Instinct	Did you build something? If not, is your blueprint specific enough that someone else could build it from your plan?
Self-Awareness	Do you know where your solution falls short? What you'd do differently with more time, skills, or context?

A Note Before You Begin

This is not a test of what you already know.

We're not looking for the candidate who has the most experience or the most complete answer. We're looking for the candidate who asks the most interesting questions, thinks most clearly in ambiguous situations, and shows us what they'd do with access to the right tools and a bit of trust. The best submissions won't come from playing it safe. They'll come from people who got genuinely curious about the problem and ran with it.

Some out-of-the-box ideas to inspire you:

- [How I and Claude\(AI\) build a Fun AI App That Talks, Roast , podcast and Think like a human — Burnlord Story](#)
- [An AI-assisted Weekend Project](#)

We look forward to seeing what you build. Most importantly, have fun!